

Detroit Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
1300 Beaubien Street, Detroit, MI 48226

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(313) 555-0177 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	DPD-26-01-31-1881	WEATHER	Black Ice / Overcast / 28°F
DATE OF INCIDENT	January 31, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Dawn / Low-light
TIME OF INCIDENT	07:22 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Black Ice (not visually apparent)
LOCATION	I-94 Westbound, Exit 219 on-ramp merge zone, Detroit, MI 48201	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	4-vehicle chain rear-end / 4 vehicles

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Detroit Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Latoya M. Griffith, Badge #5541
Officer Phone	(313) 555-0177 ext. 318
EMS Agency	Detroit EMS — Units 11 and 14 (transported three occupants)
Tow Companies	Motor City Recovery (V2, V3, V4)

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2020 Hyundai Santa Fe	5NMS3CAD8LH261801	MI-AJP-8841 (MI)	Rear bumper deformed; trunk lid warped — minor
V2	2018 Jeep Cherokee	1C4PJMCB4JD521801	MI-BRK-4418 (MI)	Front end and rear end deformed — sandwiched; both airbags deployed
V3	2022 Subaru Outback	4S4BSANC2N3341801	MI-CTX-7723 (MI)	Front bumper, hood, grille destroyed; rear bumper deformed; driver airbag deployed
V4	2019 Chevrolet Silverado	3GCUKREC0KG218801	MI-DWM-3319 (MI)	Front bumper and hood moderately deformed; airbag did not deploy

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Arthur W. Johnson	04/12/1967	MI-J44219801	None
Driver V2	Tanya R. Webb	09/24/1982	MI-W88234107	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead
Driver V3	Owen T. Carter	12/03/1991	MI-C77187213	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead
Driver V4	Bruce L. Simmons	06/17/1958	MI-S44187301	MI MCL §257.643a — Assured Clear Distance Ahead

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Dana K. Webb	11/08/1984	Serious: bilateral airbag burns; suspected rib fracture; whiplash	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 11, to Detroit Receiving Hospital (serious)
V3	Elaine B. Carter	03/27/1994	Moderate: neck pain, possible cervical strain; mild head contusion	Yes — Detroit EMS Unit 14, to Henry Ford Hospital (stable)
V3	Ryan P. Carter	07/15/2019	None — child in car seat; evaluated by EMS, no injury apparent	No
V1	Miriam L. Johnson	05/04/1969	Minor: cervical stiffness noted by EMS; declined transport	No — declined; advised to seek evaluation if symptoms persist

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Frank P. Deluca	Following motorist, pulled safely to shoulder; contact recorded	(313) 555-0344	Yes — confirmed chain sequence and estimated speeds
W2	Janice M. Okafor	Overpass pedestrian crossing — contact recorded	(313) 555-0419	Yes — observed from above; described V2, V3, V4 as traveling close together

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	Exit 219 merge zone delineator post — struck by V4 after final stop. MDOT notified.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Saturday January 31, 2026 at approximately 07:22 hrs, this officer was dispatched to I-94 westbound at the Exit 219 on-ramp merge zone in Detroit following a report of a multi-vehicle chain collision with multiple injuries. Temperature at time of incident was 28°F. Black ice was present on the roadway surface and was not visually apparent under overcast pre-dawn lighting. The incident occurred in a merge zone where on-ramp traffic regularly creates speed differentials. V1 (2020 Hyundai Santa Fe, Johnson) was traveling westbound in the right lane and slowed to accommodate merging traffic from the Exit 219 on-ramp. V1 came to a near stop. V2 (2018 Jeep Cherokee, Webb), traveling behind V1, was unable to stop in time on the icy surface and struck the rear of V1 at moderate speed. V2 then came to an angled stop blocking the right lane. V3 (2022 Subaru Outback, Carter) was traveling behind V2 and encountered the stopped vehicles; the driver applied brakes but the black ice conditions prevented adequate deceleration. V3 struck the rear of V2 with significant force, pushing V2 into V1 a second time. V4 (2019 Chevrolet Silverado, Simmons) was behind V3 and was similarly unable to stop; V4 struck the rear of V3 and then slid laterally, striking the Exit 219 delineator post on the roadway shoulder. Witness Frank Deluca was following at an estimated 15-car-length distance and was able to stop safely by initiating braking well in advance. He confirmed the four-car chain sequence occurred within approximately four seconds and stated the leading three following vehicles (V2, V3, V4) were traveling in a tight cluster. Witness Janice Okafor was crossing the I-94 overpass pedestrian bridge and had an elevated view of the sequence; she confirmed the compressed following pattern of V2, V3, and V4. V2 passenger Dana Webb sustained bilateral airbag burns, a suspected rib fracture, and significant whiplash. She was transported by Detroit EMS Unit 11 to Detroit Receiving Hospital in serious but stable condition. V3 passenger Elaine Carter was transported by Detroit EMS Unit 14 to Henry Ford Hospital with neck pain and a mild head contusion. V3 passenger Ryan Carter (age 6, child safety seat) was evaluated by EMS personnel and found uninjured. V1 passenger Miriam Johnson reported cervical stiffness; EMS evaluated and she declined transport, accepting advice to seek follow-up care. All four drivers were assessed at the scene. V2 driver Tanya Webb was treated for minor airbag abrasions and declined further transport. The remaining three drivers were uninjured. V1 was driven from the scene. V2, V3, and V4 were towed by Motor City Recovery. V2 is a probable total loss. MDOT was notified of the delineator post damage at Exit 219. Drivers Webb (V2), Carter (V3), and Simmons (V4) were each cited under MI MCL §257.643a for failure to maintain an assured clear distance ahead.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — BLACK ICE REPORTING AND MDOT COORDINATION: At 07:31 hrs, this officer contacted MDOT Region 1 Operations to report the black ice condition on I-94 westbound approaching Exit 219. MDOT dispatch confirmed that no prior ice advisory had been issued for this segment and that a sand/salt truck was in the area but had not yet reached this location. An expedited dispatch was confirmed and salt/sand treatment was applied to the affected segment between 08:05 and 08:22 hrs. MDOT has been requested to provide roadway temperature and treatment logs for the 05:00–07:30 hrs window on January 31, 2026 for I-94 westbound between Exit 217 and Exit 221. This data is relevant to any subsequent civil proceedings. **CHILD SAFETY SEAT DOCUMENTATION:** V3 passenger Ryan Carter (age 6) was restrained in a forward-facing child safety seat. Per NHTSA and Michigan OSP guidelines, the seat was involved in a moderate-to-severe collision and should be replaced. Parents were advised per Michigan Child Passenger Safety Resource (Form LE-CPSInfo) at the scene. **INJURY STATUS FOLLOW-UP:** Detroit EMS Unit 11 run report #221-88 documents Dana Webb's transport and initial assessment. A 72-hour medical update request has been submitted to Detroit Receiving Hospital Trauma Services. This report will be supplemented upon receipt of medical status confirmation. **ADDITIONAL CITATIONS UNDER REVIEW:** Given the black ice conditions, this officer has consulted with Sergeant M. Baptiste (#2241) regarding whether MI MCL §257.627 (Basic Speed Law) citations are warranted in addition to §257.643a. Determination pending sergeant review. This report is open pending that determination and medical updates.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Webb)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance Ahead — icy conditions	Civil Infraction
Driver V3 (Carter)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance Ahead — icy conditions	Civil Infraction
Driver V4 (Simmons)	MI MCL §257.643a	Assured Clear Distance Ahead — icy conditions	Civil Infraction
All — Under Review	MI MCL §257.627	Basic Speed Law (pending sergeant approval)	Under Review

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Latoya M. Griffith, Badge #5541

Investigating Officer, Detroit Police Department Traffic Services

January 31, 2026

Date